

Colombo will be a place of connecting people of the region



opportunities to boost tourism from the neighborhood. We have many challenges to attract tourists for Colombo and keeping them for couple of days in the city. Therefore we need such glamorous events to create happenings. Events like this will rewrite the brand image of Sri Lanka and will make a mammoth opportunity for us to send the message across the world that Sri Lanka is on the upswing and these kind of entertainment events are happening in Colombo”.

Speaking at the occasion Buddhika Hewawasam Chairman Sri Lanka Tourism Development Authority (SLTDA) and Sri Lanka Tourism Promotion Bureau (SLTPB) told the media that “Sri Lanka tourism is aiming to make Colombo an exciting and vibrant city and to be a hub for entertainment and music in Asia. We are doing the groundwork to open it to the world. We initially invite our immediate neighbors like India, to our northwest, and the Maldives, to our southwest”.

He revealed that all the infrastructure has been built. Hotels are ready and the city is in the actual presence to welcome all levels of tourists from the luxury high end to the downwards.

Colombo City has a spirit of music, experience of entertainment. So we need crowds to come to Colombo exactly for the purpose of visiting Colombo. There are exciting sporting events happening in Sri Lanka like T20 and various other events including weddings and MICE events. These are coming-up and Music is a bigger part to align with it”.

He further indicated that Ne-Yo the world class artist, the icon is not only coming to Sri Lanka but he is coming to Asia for the first time and begins his performance tour from Colombo. Hewawasam noted capturing from the same own words of Ne-Yo that “Connecting people from music is one part of the game”. NE-YO having said that, Hewawasam highlighted that Colombo will be a place of connecting people of the region. He thanked both the Ministry of Tourism and Ministry of Sports for supporting to implement these ventures as we want to uplift Colombo as an entertainment city.

Hewawasam pinned that the whole aim is that Music entertainment is to be offered to the world from Colombo.

Kamal Munasinghe COO of Cinnamon Hotels & Resorts told that Cinnamon Colombo Hotels will always like to partner with this kind of



[PHOTO - The Show committee attended for Press Conference at Cinnamon Grand]

entertainment events which will help us to promote Colombo as a destination and also promote Sri Lanka as a brand in the global map of tourism. He urged his fullest support to make Colombo a Vibrant destination to be full of energy, enthusiasm, activity, and life.

Colombo

is the gateway to the wonder of Asia, with its rich colonial heritage, featuring a melting pot of races, religions and cultures. A city of contrasts. It is both an eclectic mix of shiny hotels and swanky office blocks, neighboring beautiful red-tiled colonial-era buildings. Sprawling bustling street markets brim with fragrant spices, colourful silks, cottons and fresh fruit and vegetables. Discover Colombo's multi-ethnic legacy with churches, mosques and temples congregating on the same streets, and delve into iconic sites including Fort Railway Station, the Red Mosque, and the Khan Clock Tower. Plunge into Colombo's enticing street food scene, eat like a local, and immerse yourself in the sights, sounds and aromas of the whirling Pettah Bazaar. This seaside city

offers a plethora of exciting adventures, experiences and places to visit. Delight in an exhilarating tuk tuk ride around the city, relish high tea at a magnificent colonial style hotel overlooking the azure ocean, and play a round of golf on scenic green courses. A shopper's paradise, exquisite boutiques feature international brands, and charming shops offer colourful local art and textured fabrics. The home of the famed Ceylon tea, delve into the vast array of fragrant flavoured teas, including banana and brandy. Featuring a fascinating heritage and enticing culture, Sri Lanka's capital is one of Asia's favoured travel destinations. Offering a vast selection of accommodation options, including rustic beachside shacks to lavish colonial mansions and stunning hotels, every taste and desire on where to stay is fulfilled. Discover the vibrancy of Colombo and explore a variety of fascinating attractions, as well as interacting with its authentic people. Delve into the city's cultural diversity as you traverse through the colourful streets of the lively market district Pettah, Colombo's most popular district. Sample delicious street food, choose of exotic